

DEEP SALVAGE

Player Guide: How to Play, Rules and Tips

Dive, loot, survive: can you make it back up?

Plunge into a flooded harbor city, grab glowing relics, and get out before your air runs dry... or something down there finds you. Play alone or in a squad of up to 4 friends.

1. The Goal

Dive into the sunken Harbor, collect as many valuable **relics** as you can, and **get back to the surface alive**. Only relics you bring back up are yours to keep. Sell them for Coins, upgrade your gear, and dive deeper for rarer treasure.

The golden rule: loot is only yours once you climb the yellow ladder out. If you run out of air or get caught, you drop everything you were carrying.

2. How a Dive Works

Step	What to do
1. Dive	Press the DIVE button. You drop into the flooded shaft and your oxygen starts draining. Hold C to swim down.
2. Explore	Swim through the sunken city. Turn your lamp on to see, and off to hide.
3. Loot	Hold E on a relic to take it. Heavier loot fills your bag and slows you down.
4. Extract	Swim back and climb the yellow ladder out of the shaft to keep your loot.
5. Sell	Sell relics at the gold counter for Coins.
6. Upgrade	Buy better gear at the blue locker , then dive again.

3. Controls

Action	Keyboard	Gamepad	Mobile
Start a dive	DIVE button	DIVE button	DIVE button
Swim	WASD + camera	Left stick	Thumbstick
Swim up / down	Space / C or Ctrl	A / L2	Up / Down buttons
Take relic / use counter, locker, pedestal	Hold E	Hold X	Tap prompt
Sprint (hold)	Shift	L3	Sprint button
Toggle lamp	F	Y	Lamp button
Ping for your squad	G	R1	Ping button
Drop heaviest relic	X	B	Drop button
Hide UI (for clips)	H	-	-

The **SQUAD**, **BOOK** and **SHOP** buttons are at the top left of the screen.

4. The Rules

Oxygen

- You start with about **3 minutes** of air (180 seconds). The oxygen bar shows how much is left.
- **Sprinting** burns air 75% faster.
- **Carrying heavy loot** burns extra air: the more weight in your bag, the faster it drains.
- When your air gets low (below 25%), your breathing gets louder. That's your cue to head back.
- If your oxygen hits zero, you're out.

Weight and your bag

- Every relic has a **weight**. Your bag holds 10 weight to start.
- A full bag makes you swim up to **40% slower**.
- Press **X** to drop your heaviest relic. That can save your life in a chase.

Noise

- Picking up or dropping a relic makes noise. Bigger, heavier relics are louder.
- Sprinting and sonar pulses also make noise. Creatures nearby can hear it.

Getting caught, being downed and dying

- If a creature catches you or your air runs out **while a squadmate is still diving**, you are **downed** instead of dying. Your air pauses and you wait.
- A squadmate has **20 seconds** to reach you and hold the prompt for 2 seconds to **revive** you. You come back with at least 30% air.
- If nobody revives you in time, or you were diving alone, you die.
- When you die, **every relic you were carrying drops where you fell**. Squadmates can swim over and pick it up to bring it home.

Extracting

- Climb the **yellow ladder** out of the shaft. Everything in your bag goes into your inventory.
- Leaving the game during a dive does not save what you were carrying.

5. Creatures

Three things live in the Harbor. Each one hunts differently, so each one needs a different escape.

Creature	How it hunts	How to survive
The Drifter	Patrols the streets. Spots your lamp from far away (60 studs) but only notices you in the dark when you're very close. Also investigates noises.	Turn your lamp off (F) and stay still or slip away. It's slower than a sprinting diver, so sprint if your bag is light. If you're loaded, drop loot or go dark.
The Lurker	Hides in a wall vent and lunges at noise in its room. There's a short windup before each lunge.	Move quietly near vents: don't sprint, and avoid grabbing loud relics next to one. When you see it wind up, dodge sideways . It lunges at where the noise was, not where you are now.
The Warden	A rare boss that shows up when someone is carrying heavy loot : a bag 70% full, or 400+ Coins worth of relics. Leaves after a while if nobody is carrying that much.	An empty-handed diver outruns it easily. A full-bag diver can't , even while sprinting. Drop loot (X) to lighten your bag, or let a light squadmate lead it away.

6. Relics and Rarity

There are **30 relics** to find in the Harbor, in five rarities. Rarer relics are worth far more, but they're often heavier and louder.

Rarity	How common	Value (Coins)	Examples
Common	Very common	10 - 16	Rusty Compass, Copper Coin, Waterlogged Boot
Uncommon	Common	45 - 65	Brass Bell, Silver Locket, Cannonball
Rare	Uncommon	150 - 190	Captain's Logbook, Gold Pocket Watch, Mermaid Figurehead
Epic	Rare	420 - 500	Captain's Sextant, Clockwork Squid, Sunken Mayor's Seal
Legendary	Very rare	1,500 - 1,800	Drowned Crown, Heart of the Harbor

Mutations

About **1 in 50** relics spawns with a special mutation that multiplies its value:

Barnacled	Glowing	Gilded	Cursed
x1.5 value	x2 value	x3 value	x4 value

7. Gear Upgrades

Spend Coins at the **blue locker**. Each piece of gear has 5 levels.

Gear	What it improves	Level 1	Level 5
Oxygen Tank	Seconds of air	180 s	330 s
Fins	Swim speed	16	22
Salvage Bag	How much weight you can carry	10	28
Lamp	How far your light reaches	28	60
Sonar	Pulses every 5 s to reveal relics nearby. Must be bought first (400 Coins). Pulses make a little noise.	40 range	130 range

Tip: an early **Oxygen Tank** or **Salvage Bag** upgrade pays for itself fastest.

8. Daily Currents

The Harbor **rearranges itself every day**, and each day has one special current that changes the rules:

Current	Effect
Rich Currents	Rare, Epic and Legendary relics are twice as common.
Glowing Tide	Mutations are three times as likely.
Calm Waters	Your oxygen lasts about 15% longer.
Restless Deep	Creatures hear you from 50% farther away.
Collector's Market	Relics sell for 25% more.

9. Playing With a Squad

- Squads have up to **4 divers**. Open the **SQUAD** button to invite players in your server, or use **Invite Friends** to bring friends into the game. Invites last 60 seconds.
- Press **G** to **ping** a spot: point out relics, danger or the way out. Pings last 6 seconds.
- Squadmates can **revive** you when you're downed, and recover the loot you dropped if you die.
- Split the work: one diver lights the way, one carries heavy loot, one keeps watch for the Warden.

10. Your Base and the Collection Book

- Every player gets a **base plot** on the surface with **10 display pedestals**. Hold E on a pedestal to show off your best relics to everyone in the server.
- The **BOOK** button opens your Collection Book. It tracks every relic you've brought home.
- Book milestones pay rewards once: **find a mutated relic** (200 Coins + 25 Pearls), **discover half the Harbor relics** (250 Coins + 25 Pearls), and **discover all of them** (1,000 Coins + 100 Pearls + the title *Harbor Historian*).
- Pearls are spent on cosmetics in the **SHOP**.

11. Survival Tips

- Watch your oxygen bar. Head back while you still have enough air for the swim **up**, not just the swim down.
- Go dark near the Drifter. Your lamp is what it sees.
- Never sprint past a Lurker vent.
- One Legendary is worth more than a bag full of Commons. Drop junk to make room.
- If the Warden shows up, someone is carrying too much. Drop your heaviest relic and swim.
- A light, quick run that makes it home beats a greedy run that doesn't.

Good luck down there, diver.